TIME · OFF THE BEAT · LEARN

Off the beat



REMEMBER Syncopation: a note that starts between the beats and is held across the next one.

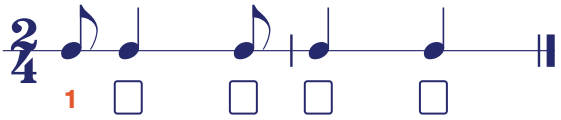
1 Find the off-beat notes ★★☆

Tap the beat. Circle every note that starts on an “&”, between the beats.



2 Count a syncopation ★★☆

Write a count in every box. Keep the beat in your foot. The first is done.



3 Swing ★☆☆

Which line shows how swung quavers are played? Circle A or B, then play both and hear the difference.

A



B



4 Foot and hands ★☆☆

Tap the beat with your foot and clap only on the “&”s. Then swap: clap the beats, tap the “&”s. Tick a circle each time it holds together.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

A syncopated note starts between the beats.	T	F
Swing quavers are written long–short.	T	F
In syncopation the beat stops for a moment.	T	F

Date _____

TIME · OFF THE BEAT · USE

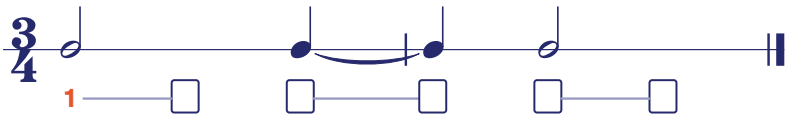
Off the beat

REMEMBER Hemiola: two bars of 3/4 felt as three big beats.

1 Hemiola

★★★

Count it in 3/4 in the boxes, then clap it feeling three minims across the two bars.



2 Clap and count

★★☆

Clap the syncopations with a metronome, counting aloud. Tick a circle each day it is steady.



3 In your music

★☆☆

Find each of these in a piece you are learning or listening to.

FIND IN A PIECE YOU ARE LEARNING	PIECE	BAR
a syncopation		
Swing written at the top		

4 Swing it

★★☆

Play a C major scale in swing quavers (“doo-ba, doo-ba”), then straight. Tick a circle each day.

5 Listen for it

★☆☆

Listen to each one and tick it when you hear what is listed.

Joplin, The Entertainer	syncopation	○
Miller, In the Mood	swing	○
Bernstein, America	hemiola	○

Date _____